
Part 1

Compliance

Section 1.1. General

1.1.1. Application of this Code

1.1.1.1. Application of this Code

- 1)** This Code applies to any one or more of the following:
 - a) the design and construction of a new *building*,
 - b) the *occupancy* of any *building*,
 - c) a change in *occupancy* of any *building*,
 - d) an *alteration* of any *building*,
 - e) an addition to any *building*,
 - f) the demolition of any *building*,
 - g) the reconstruction of any *building* that has been damaged by fire, earthquake or other cause,
 - h) the correction of an *unsafe condition* in or about any *building*,
 - i) all parts of any *building* that are affected by a change in *occupancy*,
 - j) the work necessary to ensure safety in parts of a *building*
 - i) that remain after a demolition,
 - ii) that are affected by but that are not directly involved in *alterations*, or
 - iii) that are affected by but not directly involved in additions,
 - k) except as permitted by the British Columbia Fire Code, the installation, replacement, or *alteration* of materials or equipment regulated by this Code,
 - l) the work necessary to ensure safety in a relocated *building* during and after relocation,
 - m) safety during construction of a *building*, including protection of the public,
 - n) the design, installation, extension, *alteration*, renewal or repair of *plumbing systems*, and
 - o) the *alteration*, rehabilitation and change of occupancy of *heritage buildings*.
- 2)** This Code does not apply to the following:
 - a) *sewage*, water, electrical, telephone, rail or similar public infrastructure systems located in a *street* or a public transit right of way,

- b) utility towers and poles, and television, radio and other communication aerials and towers, except for loads resulting from their being located on or attached to *buildings*,
- c) mechanical or other equipment and *appliances* not specifically regulated in these regulations,
- d) flood control and hydro electric dams and structures,
- e) accessory *buildings* less than 10 m² in *building area* that do not create a hazard,
- f) with the permission of the *authority having jurisdiction*, temporary *buildings* including
 - i) construction site offices,
 - ii) seasonal storage *buildings*,
 - iii) special events facilities,
 - iv) emergency facilities, and
 - v) similar structures,
- g) factory built housing and components complying with CSA-Z240 MH Series standard, but this exemption does not extend to on site preparations (siting, foundations, mountings), connection to services and installation of *appliances*, and
- h) areas that are specifically exempted from provincial *building* regulations by provincial or federal enactments.

3) This Code applies to both site-built and factory-constructed *buildings*. (See Note A-1.1.1.1.(3).)

4) *Farm buildings* shall conform to the requirements in the National *Farm Building* Code of Canada 1995.

5) For *heritage buildings*, the Alternate Compliance Methods for Heritage Buildings in Table 1.1.1.1.(5) may be substituted for requirements contained elsewhere in this Code. (See Note A-1.1.1.1.(5).)

Table 1.1.1.1.(5)
Alternate Compliance Methods for Heritage Buildings
 Forming Part of Sentence 1.1.1.1.(5)

No.	Code Requirement in Division B	Alternate Compliance Method
1	<i>Fire Separations</i> Sentence 3.1.3.1.(1), Table 3.1.3.1., Subsection 9.10.9. 2 h <i>fire separation</i> required between some <i>major occupancies</i> .	Except for F1 <i>occupancies</i> , 1 h <i>fire separation</i> is acceptable, provided the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> .
2	<i>Fire Separations</i> Sentence 3.1.3.1.(1), Table 3.1.3.1., Subsection 9.10.9. 1 h <i>fire separation</i> required between some <i>major occupancies</i> .	30 min <i>fire separation</i> is acceptable if the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> .
3	<i>Noncombustible Construction</i> Subsection 3.1.5., Article 9.10.6.1. All materials used in <i>noncombustible construction</i> must be <i>noncombustible</i> unless otherwise permitted.	1. Roofs may be of <i>combustible construction</i> provided the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> . 2. Up to 10% gross <i>floor area</i> to a maximum of 10% of any one <i>floor area</i> may be of <i>combustible construction</i> provided the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> .
4	<i>Fire-resistance Rating</i> Sentence 3.1.7.1.(1), Article 9.10.3.1. Where a material, assembly of materials or structural	A <i>fire-resistance rating</i> may also be used based on: (a) HUD No. 8 Guideline on Fire Ratings of Archaic Materials and Assemblies., (b) Fire Endurance of Protected Steel Columns and Beams, DBR Technical Paper No. 194.,

Table 1.1.1.1.(5) (continued)

No.	Code Requirement in Division B	Alternate Compliance Method
	member is required to have a <i>fire-resistance rating</i> it shall be tested in accordance with CAN/ULC-S101, "Fire Endurance Tests of Building Construction Materials."	(c) Fire Endurance of Unit Masonry Walls, DBR Technical Paper No. 207., (d) Fire Endurance of Light-Framed and Miscellaneous Assemblies, DBR Technical Paper No. 222.
5	Rating of Supporting Construction Article 3.1.7.5., Article 9.10.8.3. Supporting assemblies to have <i>fire-resistance rating</i> at least equivalent to that of the supported floor.	<i>Heavy timber construction</i> is permitted to have a <i>fire-resistance rating</i> less than would be required by the Code provided the <i>building</i> : (a) is <i>sprinklered</i> , and (b) does not exceed 6 <i>storeys</i> in <i>building height</i> .
6	Continuity of <i>Fire Separations</i> Sentence 3.1.8.3.(1), Sentence 3.1.8.3.(2), Article 9.10.9.2. <i>Fire separations</i> are required to be continuous above the ceiling space.	<i>Fire separations</i> are not required to be continuous above a ceiling space where (a) the ceiling space is <i>noncombustible construction</i> , (b) both <i>fire compartments</i> are <i>sprinklered</i> , or (c) the ceiling has a minimum rating of 30 minutes.
7	Wired Glass Sentence 3.1.8.5.(1), Sentence 3.1.8.14.(2), Article 9.10.13.1., Article 9.10.13.5. 6 mm wired glass in steel frame required in <i>fire separations</i> .	For fixed transoms or sidelights, 6 mm wired glass fixed to a wood frame of at least 50 mm thickness with steel stops is permitted in a required <i>fire separation</i> .
8	<i>Mezzanines</i> Sentence 3.2.1.1.(4) and Sentence 3.2.1.1.(7), Article 9.10.4.1. <i>Mezzanines</i> enclosing more than 10% above the horizontal plane are considered as <i>storey</i> in <i>building height</i> .	Enclosed <i>mezzanines</i> may be up to 40% of the <i>storey</i> in which they occur and not be considered a <i>storey</i> in <i>building height</i> if the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> .
9	<i>Building Height</i> Article 3.2.2.20. to Article 3.2.2.90. <i>Noncombustible construction</i> required for some <i>buildings</i> .	<i>Buildings</i> may be of <i>combustible construction</i> up to 6 <i>storeys</i> provided: (a) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> , (b) the <i>building</i> contains Group C, D, E, F, Division 2 or F, Division 3 <i>occupancies</i> , and (c) floor assemblies not required to exceed 1 h <i>fire separation</i> requirements may be of <i>heavy timber construction</i> .
10	Spatial Separation Subsection 3.2.3., Subsection 9.10.14. The area of <i>unprotected opening</i> shall not exceed the limits in Tables 3.2.3.1.A to Table 3.2.3.1.E	The area of <i>unprotected opening</i> is not limited provided: (a) the <i>limiting distance</i> is a minimum 1 m, (b) the <i>building</i> has a supervised sprinkler system in conformance with Sentence 3.2.4.9.(3), and (c) the sprinkler system is connected to the fire department in conformance with Sentence 3.2.4.7.(4).
11	Construction of <i>Exposing Building Face</i> Article 3.2.3.7., Article 9.10.14.5. The <i>exposing building face</i> is required to have a <i>fire-resistance rating</i> and/or be of <i>noncombustible construction</i> .	<i>Exposing building face</i> is not required to have a <i>fire-resistance rating</i> if the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> . Also, the <i>exposing building face</i> is not required to be of <i>noncombustible construction</i> if it is protected by an exterior sprinkler system conforming to NFPA 13, "Installation of Sprinkler Systems."
12	Roof Covering Rating Sentence 3.1.15.2.(1) Class A, B or C roof covering in conformance with CAN/ULC-S107, "Fire Tests of Roof Coverings" required.	For existing roofs not covered by a Class A, B or C roofing a manually operated deluge system in accordance with NFPA 13, "Installation of Sprinkler Systems" is permitted.

Table 1.1.1.1.(5) (continued)

No.	Code Requirement in Division B	Alternate Compliance Method
13	Smoke Alarms Sentence 3.2.4.20.(7), Sentence 9.10.19.4.(1) <i>Smoke alarms</i> are required to be connected to an electric circuit.	<i>Smoke alarms</i> may be battery operated in single family homes only.
14	Interconnected Floor Space Subsection 3.2.8., Sentence 9.10.1.3.(6)	1. Open stairs in <i>buildings</i> of maximum 4 <i>storeys</i> in <i>building height</i> need not comply with Subsection 3.2.8., provided (a) the <i>building</i> contains a Group C or D <i>occupancy</i>, (b) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> with fast-response sprinklers, (c) corridors opening into the <i>interconnected floor space</i> are separated from the <i>interconnected floor space</i> by a <i>fire separation</i> with the rating required for the corridor, and (d) <i>smoke detectors</i> are installed in the rooms opening into the <i>interconnected floor space</i> and the <i>smoke detectors</i> are connected to the fire alarm system. 2. Open stairs in <i>buildings</i> of maximum 3 <i>storeys</i> in <i>building height</i>, or first 2 <i>storeys</i> and <i>basement</i>, need not comply with Subsection 3.2.8. of Division B, provided: (a) the <i>building</i> contains a Group C or D <i>occupancy</i>, (b) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> with fast response sprinklers, (c) <i>smoke detectors</i> are installed in the rooms opening into the <i>interconnected floor space</i> and the <i>smoke detectors</i> are connected to the fire alarm system, and (d) at least one <i>means of egress</i> is not through the <i>interconnected floor space</i>.
15	Separation of Suites Article 3.3.1.1., Article 9.10.9.13., Article 9.10.9.14. <i>Suites</i> are required to be separated from adjoining <i>suites</i> by a <i>fire separation</i> having a fire resistance rating of 45 min or 1 hr.	Existing <i>fire separations</i> of 30 min, such as wood lath and plaster in good condition, are acceptable in <i>sprinklered buildings</i> not exceeding 6 <i>storeys</i> in <i>building height</i>.
16	Corridor fire separation Article 3.3.1.4., Article 9.10.9.15. <i>Public corridors</i> are required to be separated from the remainder of the <i>building</i> by a <i>fire separation</i> having a <i>fire-resistance rating</i> of at least 45 min.	Existing corridors with 30 min fire resistance ratings, such as wood lath and plaster in good condition, are acceptable in <i>residential occupancies</i> provided the <i>building</i>: (a) does not exceed 6 <i>storeys</i> in <i>building height</i>, and (b) is fully <i>sprinklered</i> with fast response sprinklers.
17	Corridor Width Article 3.3.1.9., Subsection 3.4.3., Article 9.9.3.3. <i>Public corridors</i> and <i>exit corridors</i> are permitted to have a minimum width of 1 100 mm.	<i>Public corridors</i> and <i>exit corridors</i> are permitted with a minimum width of 800 mm provided: (a) the <i>occupant load</i> of the <i>building</i> is maximum 20 people, and (b) the <i>building</i> does not exceed 3 <i>storeys</i> in <i>building height</i>.
18	Door Swing Article 3.3.1.10., Article 3.4.6.12., Article 9.9.6.5. Doors required to swing in the direction of <i>exit</i> travel.	2nd egress door from a room is not required to swing in the direction of <i>exit</i> travel provided: (a) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> and the system is supervised in conformance with Sentence 3.2.4.9.(3), and (b) the <i>occupant load</i> of the <i>building</i> is maximum 100 people.

Table 1.1.1.1.(5) (continued)

No.	Code Requirement in Division B	Alternate Compliance Method
19	Stairs, <i>Ramps</i> , Handrails and <i>Guards</i> Article 3.3.1.14., Article 3.3.1.16., Article 3.3.1.18., Articles 3.4.6.5 to 3.4.6.79., Section 9.8.	Existing conditions that do not comply fully with the requirements are permitted if they are acceptable to the <i>authority having jurisdiction</i> .
20	Transparent Doors and Panels Article 3.3.1.19., Article 9.6.1.4. Safety glass required.	Existing glass or transparent panels that do not comply fully with the requirements are permitted if sufficiently discernible or <i>guards</i> are provided in hazardous situations.
21	Dead-end Corridors Sentence 3.3.1.9.(7), Article 9.9.7.3. Dead-end corridors are permitted to a maximum length of 6 m.	1. Dead-end corridors are permitted to a maximum length of 10 m in Group C <i>occupancies</i> provided: (a) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> with fast response sprinklers, and (b) <i>smoke detectors</i> are installed in the corridor system. 2. Dead-end corridors are permitted to a maximum of 15 m in length in Group D, E, F, Division 2 and F, Division 3 <i>occupancies</i> provided: (a) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> with fast response sprinklers, and (b) <i>smoke detectors</i> are installed in the corridor system.
22	<i>Exits</i> Article 3.4.2.1., Article 9.9.8.2. <i>Floor areas</i> shall be served by not fewer than 2 <i>exits</i> except as permitted by Sentence 3.4.2.1.(2).	<i>Floor areas</i> may be served by a single <i>exit</i> within the limits of Sentence 3.4.2.1.(2) provided: (a) the <i>building</i> does not exceed 3 <i>storeys</i> in <i>building height</i> , (b) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> with fast response sprinklers, and (c) all <i>floor areas</i> are protected by a system of <i>smoke detectors</i> connected to a fire alarm system.
23	Reduction of <i>Exit</i> Width Sentence 3.4.3.3.(2), Article 9.9.6.1. Swinging doors in their swing shall not reduce the effective width of <i>exit</i> stairs and landings to less than 750 mm.	Existing swinging doors in their swing are permitted to reduce the effective width of <i>exit</i> stairs and landings to a minimum of 550 mm provided: (a) they serve Group C or D <i>occupancies</i> , (b) the <i>building</i> does not exceed 4 <i>storeys</i> in <i>building height</i> , and (c) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> .
24	<i>Fire Separation of Exits</i> Article 3.4.4.1., Subsection 9.9.4. <i>Exits</i> are required to be separated from the remainder of the <i>floor area</i> by a <i>fire separation</i> having a <i>fire-resistance rating</i> of not less than required by Subsection 3.2.2. , but not less than 45 min.	1. <i>Buildings</i> of 3 <i>storeys</i> or less may have <i>exits</i> that are separated by a <i>fire separation</i> that does not have a <i>fire-resistance rating</i> provided: (a) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> with fast response sprinklers, and (b) the sprinkler system is supervised in accordance with Sentence 3.2.4.9.(3). 2. <i>Buildings</i> not exceeding 6 <i>storeys</i> in <i>building height</i> may have <i>exits</i> that are separated by a <i>fire separation</i> having a fire resistance rating of not less than 45 min provided the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> .
25	<i>Exits Through Lobbies</i> Article 3.4.4.2., Article 9.9.8.5. Rooms adjacent to the lobby are required to be separated by a <i>fire separation</i> .	Rooms adjacent to the lobby are not required to be separated by a <i>fire separation</i> provided: (a) the <i>floor area</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> with fast response sprinklers, and (b) <i>smoke detectors</i> are installed in the adjacent rooms.
26	Rooms Opening into <i>Exit</i> Sentence 3.4.4.4.(7), Article 9.9.5.9. <i>Service rooms</i> and ancillary rooms are not permitted to open directly into an <i>exit</i> .	<i>Service rooms</i> and ancillary rooms may open directly into an <i>exit</i> provided: (a) the room is <i>sprinklered</i> with fast response sprinklers, and (b) weatherstripping is installed on the door to prevent the passage of smoke.

Table 1.1.1.1.(5) (continued)

No.	Code Requirement in Division B	Alternate Compliance Method
27	Illumination of <i>Exit</i> Signs Sentence 3.4.5.1.(3) and 3.4.5.1.(4) , Sentence 9.9.11.3.(3) and 9.9.11.3.(4) <i>Exit</i> signs are required to be illuminated continuously while the <i>building</i> is occupied.	Where <i>exit</i> signage may compromise historic appearances, or authenticity of displays, <i>exit</i> signs may be installed to light only on an emergency condition, such as by the fire alarm system or due to power failure.
28	Clearance from <i>Exit</i> Doors Sentence 3.4.6.11.(1), Article 9.9.6.6. Stair risers shall not be closer than 300 mm from an <i>exit</i> door.	Except as permitted in Sentences 3.4.6.11.(3) or 9.6.6.(2), existing <i>exit</i> doors shall not extend beyond the first riser.
29	Fire Escapes Subsection 3.4.7., Sentence 9.9.2.1.(2) Fire escapes are required to conform to Subsection 3.4.7.	Existing fire escapes that do not completely conform to Subsection 3.4.7. are acceptable provided: (a) the fire escapes are acceptable and (b) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> .
30	Fire Escape Construction Article 3.4.7.2., Sentence 9.9.2.1.(2)	Existing <i>combustible</i> fire escapes are permitted if the <i>building</i> is permitted to be of <i>combustible construction</i> by Part 3, Part 9 or by this Table.
31	Protection of Fire Escapes Article 3.4.7.4., Sentence 9.9.2.1.(2) Openings in the exterior wall adjacent to the fire escape are required to be protected by <i>closures</i> .	Existing openings in the exterior wall adjacent to the fire escape are not required to be protected by <i>closures</i> provided: (a) the <i>building</i> is <i>sprinklered</i> , and (b) a sprinkler head is located within 1.5 m of the opening required to be protected by Article 3.4.7.4.
32	<i>Vertical Service Space</i> Article 3.6.3.1. <i>Vertical service spaces</i> are required to be separated from the adjacent <i>floor area</i> by a rated <i>fire separation</i> .	Existing <i>vertical service spaces</i> that do not completely conform to the rated <i>fire separation</i> requirements are acceptable provided the <i>vertical service spaces</i> are <i>sprinklered</i> .
33	Height of Rooms Subsection 3.7.1., Section 9.5. The height of rooms is required to comply to minimum dimension requirements.	Existing rooms are not required to comply to the minimum dimension requirements of Subsection 3.7.1. or Subsection 9.5.3.
34	Washroom Requirements Subsection 3.7.2., Section 9.31. <i>Buildings</i> are required to be provided with a minimum number of washroom fixtures.	Existing facilities are not required to completely comply to the requirements of Subsection 3.7.2. or Section 9.31. provided it is acceptable to the <i>authority having jurisdiction</i> .
35	<i>Access for Persons with Disabilities</i> Section 3.8. of Division B	Article 3.8.4.5. shall apply to existing <i>buildings</i> .
36	Seismic Anchorage of Exterior Decoration Subsection 4.1.8.	Existing exterior decorations are not required to fully comply to the anchorage requirements of Subsection 4.1.8. provided: (a) adequate means of protection is provided, or (b) there is no exposure to the public.
37	Mechanical and <i>Plumbing Systems</i> Part 6 and Part 7	Existing mechanical and <i>plumbing systems</i> in <i>buildings</i> are not required to fully comply to the requirements of Parts 6 or Part 7 provided: (a) it is not an <i>unsafe condition</i> and (b) it is acceptable to the <i>authority having jurisdiction</i> .

6) For the design and construction of *alterations* to existing *buildings* to add a *secondary suite*, not including the design and construction of new additions or new *buildings*, the Alternate Compliance Methods for Alterations to Existing Buildings to Add a Secondary Suite in Table 1.1.1.1.(6) may be substituted for requirements contained elsewhere in this Code. (See Note A-1.1.1.1.(6).)

Table 1.1.1.1.(6)
Alternate Compliance Methods for Alterations to Existing Buildings to Add a Secondary Suite
 Forming Part of Sentence 1.1.1.1.(6)

No	Code Requirement in Division B	Alternate Compliance Method (References to Division B)
1	Reinforcement for Grab Bars Sentence 3.8.5.1.(2) One bathroom in a <i>secondary suite</i> shall have walls adjacent the water closer and shower or bathtub location reinforced to accommodate the future installation of grab bars.	Reinforcement to accommodate the future installation of grab bars is not required in existing bathrooms serving a <i>secondary suite</i> .
2	Ceiling Heights of Rooms or Spaces Sentence 9.5.3.1.(1) and Table 9.5.3.1. Ceiling height shall be not less than 2.1 m over the minimum area required in Table 9.5.3.1.	Except as required by Sentence 9.9.3.4.(3), the minimum ceiling heights in a <i>secondary suite</i> over the required area as indicated in Table 9.5.3.1. shall be not less than 1.95 m. It shall be possible to travel from the required area of one room to the required areas of all other rooms within the <i>secondary suite</i> without reduction of the ceiling height to less than 1.95 m. Except as required by Sentence 9.9.3.4.(3), the minimum clear height under beams and ducting, including where located over stairs, in a <i>secondary suite</i> shall be not less than 1.85 m.
3	Doorway Opening Sizes Sentence 9.5.5.1.(1) and Table 9.5.5.1. Doorway openings shall be designed to accommodate swing-type and folding doors not less than 1 980 mm high.	Except for <i>exit</i> doors and for doors serving <i>public corridors</i> and <i>exit</i> corridors that serve a house with a <i>secondary suite</i> , doorway openings within a <i>secondary suite</i> shall be designed to accommodate swing-type and folding doors not less than 1 890 mm high.
4	Height over Stairs Sentence 9.8.2.2.(3) The clear height over stairs shall be not less than 1950 mm.	Except for stairs in a <i>public corridor</i> or <i>exit</i> corridor that serve a house with a <i>secondary suite</i> , the clear height over stairs that are located under existing beams and existing ducting in a house with a <i>secondary suite</i> shall be not less than 1 850 mm.
5	Openings Near Unenclosed Exterior <i>Exit</i> Stairs and <i>Ramps</i> Sentence 9.9.4.4.(1) <i>Unprotected openings</i> in exterior walls that are within 3 m horizontally and less than 10 m below or less than 5 m above an unenclosed exterior <i>exit</i> stair or <i>ramp</i> of a house with a <i>secondary suite</i> shall be protected where the unenclosed exterior <i>exit</i> stair or <i>ramp</i> provides the only <i>means of egress</i> from a <i>suite</i> and is exposed to fire from <i>unprotected openings</i> in the exterior walls of another <i>dwelling unit</i> , ancillary space or common space.	Protection of the <i>unprotected openings</i> as described in Sentence 9.9.4.4.(1) is not required when all <i>smoke alarms</i> within a house with a <i>secondary suite</i> are of photo-electric type and interconnected as described in Clause 9.10.19.5.(2)(a).
6	Openings Near <i>Exit</i> Doors Sentence 9.9.4.6.(1) Where an exterior <i>exit</i> door in one <i>fire compartment</i> is within 3 m horizontally of an <i>unprotected opening</i> in another <i>fire compartment</i> and the exterior walls of these <i>fire compartments</i> intersect at an exterior angle of less than 135°, the opening shall be protected.	Protection of the <i>unprotected openings</i> as described in Sentence 9.9.4.6.(1) is not required when all <i>smoke alarms</i> within a house with a <i>secondary suite</i> are of photo-electric type and interconnected as described in Clause 9.10.19.5.(2)(a).

Table 1.1.1.1.(6) (continued)

No	Code Requirement in Division B	Alternate Compliance Method (References to Division B)
7	Fire-Resistance and Fire-Protection Ratings Sentence 9.10.3.1.(3) In a house with a <i>secondary suite</i>, where a minimum <i>fire-resistance rating</i> of 30 min is permitted, it is permitted to use wood-frame construction where stud and joist spaces are filled with absorptive material, resilient metal channel spaced 400 or 600 mm o.c. is on one side and not less than 12.7 mm thick gypsum board is installed on ceilings and on both sides of walls.	Adding resilient metal channel spaced 400 or 600 mm o.c. and an additional layer of not less than 12.7 mm gypsum board to one side of an existing finished wall assembly that has not less than 12.7 mm gypsum board on each side or an existing finished floor-ceiling assembly that has not less than 12.7 mm gypsum on the ceiling side is permitted to be used where a 30 min <i>fire-resistance rating</i> is required.
8	Fire-Resistance Ratings for Walls, Columns and Arches Sentence 9.10.8.3.(1) <i>Loadbearing</i> walls, columns and arches in the <i>storey</i> immediately below a floor or roof assembly shall have a <i>fire-resistance rating</i> of not less than that required for the supported floor or roof assembly.	Except for heavy timber elements and those of masonry or concrete construction, light frame walls, columns, arches and beams as well as <i>loadbearing</i> steel elements that support floors between <i>dwelling units</i> in a house with a <i>secondary suite</i> including their common spaces shall be protected by not less than 12.7 mm thick gypsum board.
9	Sound Transmission Sentence 9.11.1.1.(2) Each <i>dwelling unit</i> shall be separated from every other space in a house with a <i>secondary suite</i> in which noise may be transmitted by construction having joist and stud spaces <i>filled</i> with sound-absorbing material, resilient channel on one side of the separation, and 12.7 mm thick gypsum board on ceilings and on both sides of walls, or by either construction providing an STC rating of not less than 43, or by using a separating assembly and adjoining construction providing an ASTC rating of not less than 40.	The assemblies and adjoining constructions that separate the <i>dwelling units</i> in a house with a <i>secondary suite</i> including their common spaces need not comply with Clause 9.11.1.1.(2)(a) where resilient metal channel spaced 400 or 600 mm o.c. and an additional layer of not less than 12.7 mm gypsum board is added to one side of an existing finished assembly.

1.1.1.2. Application to Existing Buildings

1) Where a *building* is altered, rehabilitated, renovated or repaired, or there is a change in *occupancy*, the level of life safety and *building* performance shall not be decreased below a level that already exists. (See Note A-1.1.1.2.(1).)

1.1.2. Internal References to this Code

1.1.2.1. Book I (General) and Book II (Plumbing Systems) of the Code

1) This is the first of the two Books, Book I (General) and Book II (Plumbing Systems), that together form the British Columbia Building Code.

1.1.2.2. Internal References to the Code

1) Unless a Book is specified, references to “the British Columbia Building Code,” “the Code,” “this Code” and the like shall be read as references to the Book in which they appear.

1.1.3. Appendices, Notes and Annotations

1.1.3.1. Appendices, Notes and References to Appendices and Notes have No Legal Effect

1) Except for Notes A-Table 9.23.3.5.-B and A-9.23.13., including Table A-9.23.13. in Division B, Notes to Parts of this Code have no legal effect.

Section 1.2. Compliance

1.2.1. Compliance with this Code

1.2.1.1. Compliance with this Code

- 1)** Compliance with this Code shall be achieved by
- a) complying with the applicable acceptable solutions in Division B (see Note A-1.2.1.1.(1)(a)), or
 - b) except as required by Sentence (3), using alternative solutions, accepted by the *authority having jurisdiction* under Section 2.3 of Division C, that will achieve at least the minimum level of performance required by Division B in the areas defined by the objectives and functional statements attributed to the applicable acceptable solutions (see Note A-1.2.1.1.(1)(b)).

2) For the purposes of compliance with this Code as required in Clause 1.2.1.1.(1)(b), the objectives and functional statements attributed to the acceptable solutions in Division B shall be the objectives and functional statements referred to in Subsection 1.1.2. of Division B.

3) An alternative solution shall not be used in place of an acceptable solution if the acceptable solution expressly requires conformance to a provincial enactment other than Book I (General) or Book II (Plumbing Systems) of the British Columbia Building Code.

1.2.1.2. Responsibility of Owner

1) Unless otherwise specified in this Code, the *owner* of a *building* shall be the person responsible for carrying out the provisions of this Code in relation to that *building*.

2) The *owner* of a *building* is in no way relieved of full responsibility for complying with this Code by the *authority having jurisdiction*

- a) granting a building permit,
- b) approving drawings or specifications, or
- c) carrying out inspections.

1.2.2. Materials, Appliances, Systems and Equipment

1.2.2.1. Characteristics of Materials, Appliances, Systems and Equipment

1) All materials, *appliances*, systems and equipment installed to meet the requirements of this Code shall possess the necessary characteristics to perform their intended functions when installed in a *building*.